MONIKA

Master's student in Marketing Analytics and Data Intelligence at Paris School of Business, combining data-driven insight with strategic marketing thinking.

TOTAL SALES
$2.30M
2011-2014

TOTAL PROFIT
$287K
12.5% margin

SUPERSTORE SALES DASHBOARD ANALYSIS

Where does the business make money, and where does it lose it? A Google Data Studio dashboard and profit-improvement recommendations built on 2011-2014 sales data.

UNIQUE ORDERS
5,009
9,994 order lines

REGIONS / CATEGORIES
4 / 3
21 data columns

Tools : Google Sheets (Cleaning) | Google Data Studio (Dashboard)

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Objective, data and approach

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate overall business performance, identify the main revenue and profit drivers across regions, categories and time, and turn the findings into actions that improve profitability.

APPROACH

1. **Clean :** Collected and cleaned the Superstore dataset in Google Sheets.
2. **Measure :** Defined KPIs (sales, profit, margin, orders) and validated them against the raw data.
3. **Visualise :** Built a 2-page interactive dashboard in Data Studio: performace overview, then profit drivers.
4. **Recommend :** Tied every recommendation to a chart that supports it.

Dataset at a glance

PERIOD
JAN 2011 – DEC 2014

ORDER LINES (ROWS)
9,994

UNIQUE ORDERS (ORDER ID)
5,009

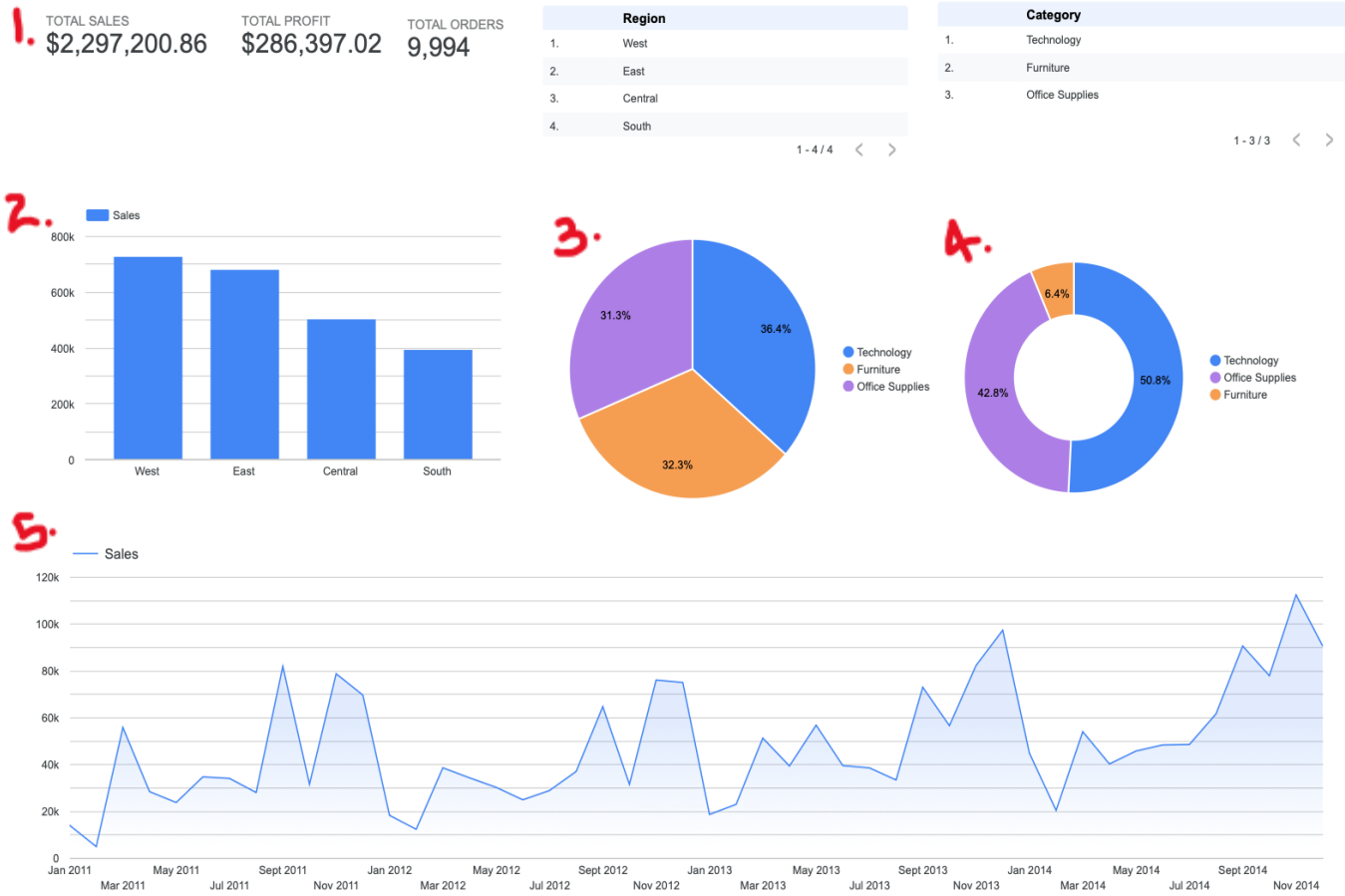
COLUMNS
21 (Order ID, Date, Region, Category, Sales, Profit.....)

REGIONS
East, West, Central. South

CATEGORIES
Technology, Furniture, Office Supplies

DASHBOARD – PAGE 1 : PERFORMANCE OVERVIEW

Interactive Data Studio Dashboard (screenshot)



1. KPIs

Sales $2.30M, profit $287K, 9,994 order lines (5,009 unique orders).

2. Sales by region

West leads, South is lowest.

3. Sales share by category

Three near-equal slices: Technology 36%, Furniture 32%, Office Supplies 31%

4. Profit share by category.

Technology 51%, Office Supplies 43%, Furniture only 6%.

5. Monthly sales trend

Seasonal, with Q4 peaks and an upward trend.

KEY FINDINGS

What the numbers say

Sales vs profit by category

Category	Sales	Sales Share	Profit	Margin
Technology	$836K	36.4%	~$145K	~17%
Office Supplies	$719K	31.3%	~$123K	~17%
Furniture	$742K	32.3%	~$18K	~2.5%

Furniture brings in a third of sales but only 6% of profit

Sales by region

Region	Sales	Share
West	$725K	31.6%
East	$679K	29.6%
Central	$501K	21.8%
South	$392K	17.1%

~ = derived from category profit share x total profit ($286,397).

Takeaways

- **Overall :** $2.30M sales and $287K profit, a 12.5% margin across 9,994 order lines.
- **Regions:** West is the largest market; South the smallest, at roughly half of West.
- **Categories:** Sales are evenly split across categories, but profit is not. Technology and Office Supplies carry the business.
- **Trend:** Sales are seasonal: Q4 peaks every year, Jan-Feb lows. Low of ~$5K (Feb 2011), peak of ~$112K (Nov 2014).
- **Direction:** Growth is clear: 2013-2014 peaks sit well above 2011-2012.

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

(Five actions to improve profitability, each backed by dashboard chart on Page 3)

1. **Control discounting** : Discounts above 20% are the biggest profit drain: mid discounts cut profit by ~25%, high discounts by up to 77%* versus undiscounted orders. Cap discounts at 20%.

Profit by discount band
SEE CHART

2. **Fix weak sub-categories** : Tables lose the most (~$17.7K, ~8.6% margin)*, and Bookcases are also unprofitable. Reprice, cut costs, or limit their shares of sales

Profit by sub-category
SEE CHART

3. **Review loss-making states** : Texas, Ohio, Pennsylvania and Illinois lose over $70K combined* despite high sales. Heavy discounting is the likely cause, so adjust pricing there.

Bottom 5 states by profit
SEE CHART

4. **Promote high-margin products** : Copiers and Paper deliver margins of 37-43%*. Increase marketing and sales focus on them.

Profit by sub-category
SEE CHART

5. **Invest in the west region** : The West leads in both sales ($725K) and margin (14.9%)*. More investment can drive higher returns.

Margin by region
SEE CHART